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Windows 365 Licensing Unlocked

Beyond the Docs & Into the Real World

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Microsoft

baseVISION
SECURE & MODERN ENDPOINT MANAGEMENT

EPIC FUSION
BRING IT ALL TOGETHER

About “Lukas Rottach”

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Focus

Azure Platform, Cloud Adoption, Automation, Desktop Virtualization Technologies

Certifications

A lot… 😅

Picture

From

Zurich

Hobbies

Music, Photography, Cats

My Blog

https://lrottach.hashnode.dev

Contact

https://www.linkedin.com/in/lrottach/

Agenda

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- Timeline
- Windows 365 Business
- Real world project
- Enterprise vs Frontline
- Closing

Key takeaways:

- Overview of the different Windows 365 offerings
- Inspirations when to use what

Windows 365
Azure Virtual Desktop

Timeline

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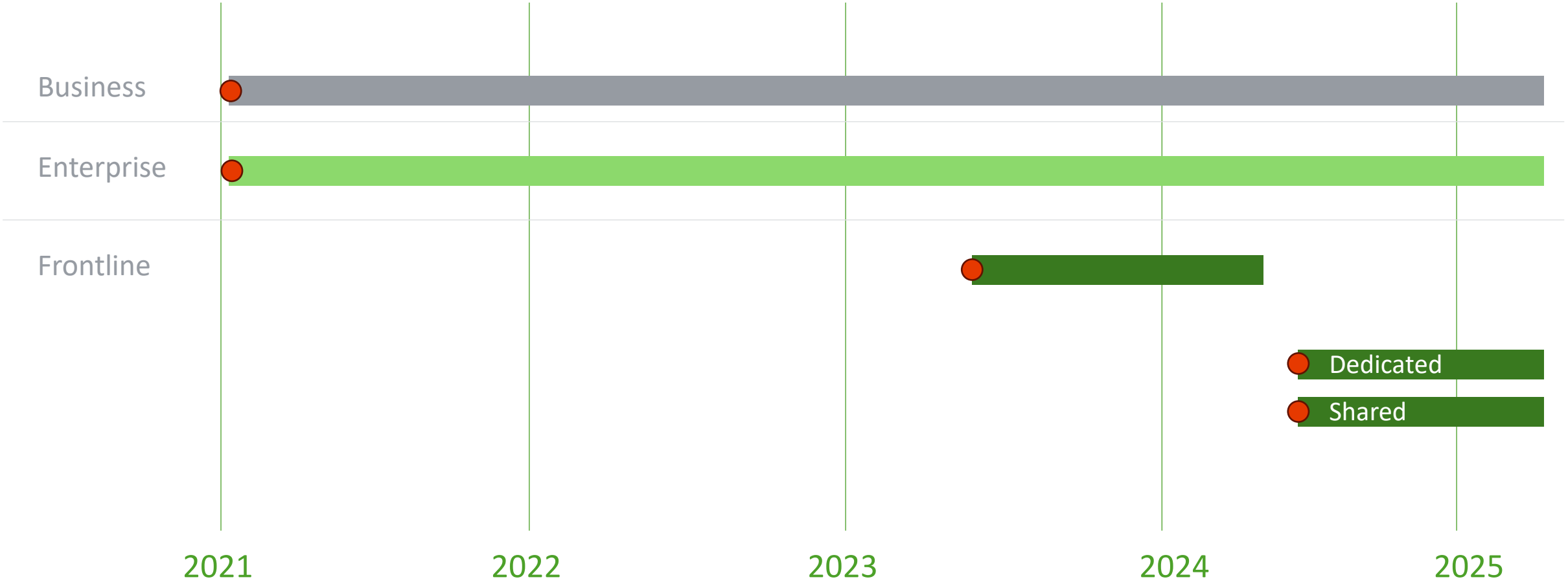

Why not to use Windows 365 Business

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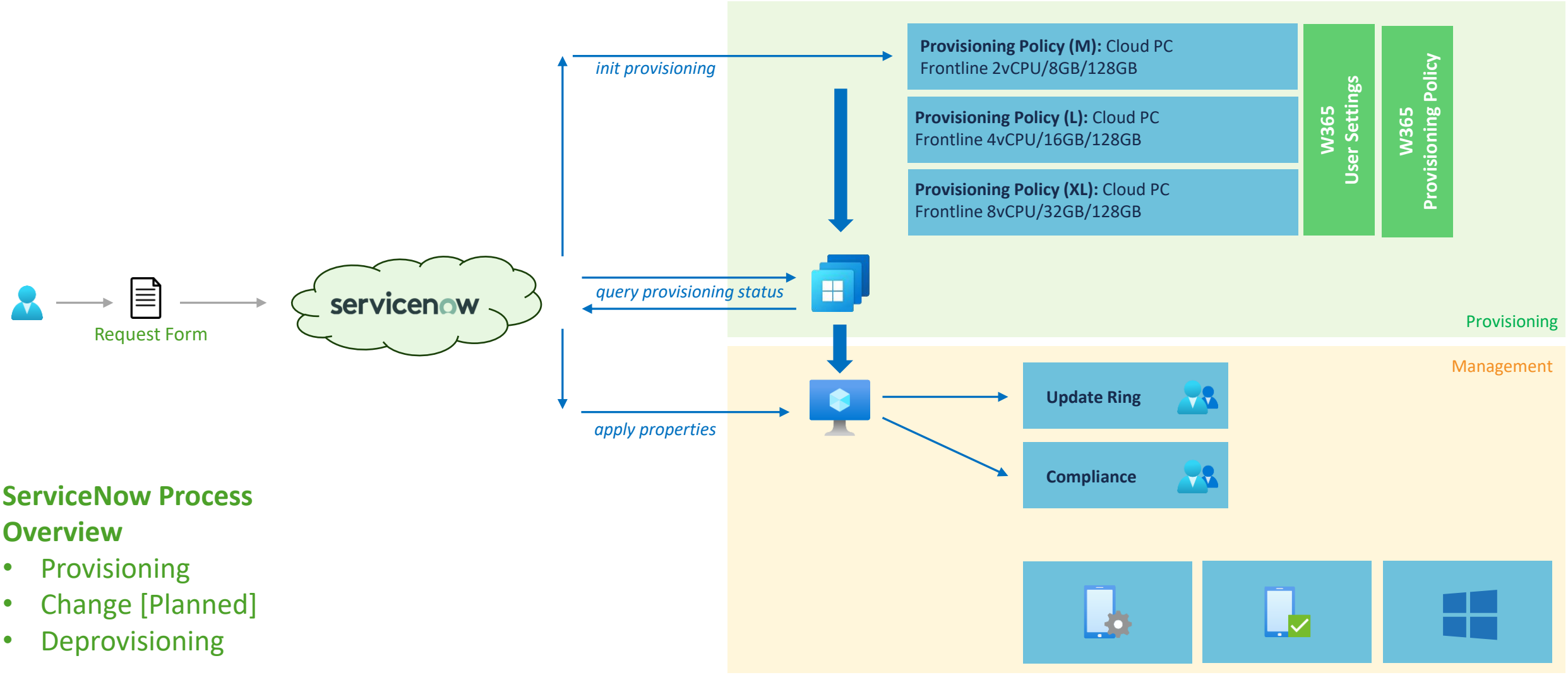
- No license pre-requisites, but more expensive
- Only minimal integration with Microsoft Intune
- No support for custom provisioning policies
- Restricted device management
- No customer image-support
- No Azure Hybrid AD join
- No Azure Virtual Network integration
- Maximum of 300 licenses per tenant
- Not available through EA
- Limited feature availability

Check this out: https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/windows-365/business-enterprise-comparison

A real-world project!

Architecture (High-Level)



ServiceNow Process Overview

- Provisioning
- Change [Planned]
- Deprovisioning

Personas / Workload Types

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#1 External Developer

- Using customer-internal collaboration tools
- Heavy development environments
- Nested Virtualization (Docker, WSL2, …)
- Needs access to internal databases, repos and documentation

#2 Partner Companies

- Customer-internal collaboration
- Consumes internal developed applications
- Needs access to internal services and documentation

#3 Graphic Intense Workloads

- Works on internal CAD-projects
- Using massive CAD application-suits

Infrequent usage! Calculation is King!

Enterprise vs Frontline

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	Windows 365 Enterprise ($$)	Windows 365 Frontline ($$$)
Licensing	Single license per user	Up to three users share one Frontline license
Target audience	Full-time employees	Frontline/Shift workers, Part-time employees
Experience	Dedicated, always accessible desktop	Shared access
Session behavior	Always-on	Auto-Shutdown
Network	Microsoft-managed, Azure Network Connection	Microsoft-managed, Azure Network Connection
Windows Updates	As known	Special :D
Limitations	None	No resizing, no cross-region disaster recovery

Configure Windows Update for Windows 365 Frontline Cloud PCs

Article • 02/25/2025 • 1 contributor

Feedback

In this article

Automatic sync updates for Frontline Cloud PCs in dedicated mode that haven't been connected for seven days
Next steps

Windows 365 Frontline Cloud PCs rely on active hours Windows Update policies to make sure that Cloud PCs don't reboot for Windows Update during active usage. The following table lists recommended update configurations for Frontline Cloud PCs. Make sure to use the Filter function or create a dynamic device group to target the policies only to your Frontline Cloud PCs.

Check this out: https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/windows-365/enterprise/windows-update-frontline-cloud-pc

The new kid on the block…

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- **Non-Persistent Sessions:** User profiles and data are automatically deleted upon sign-out
- **Single Concurrent Access:** Each shared Cloud PC supports one active user session at a time
- **Cost-Efficient Licensing:** Purchase licenses based on the number of concurrent users rather than individual users

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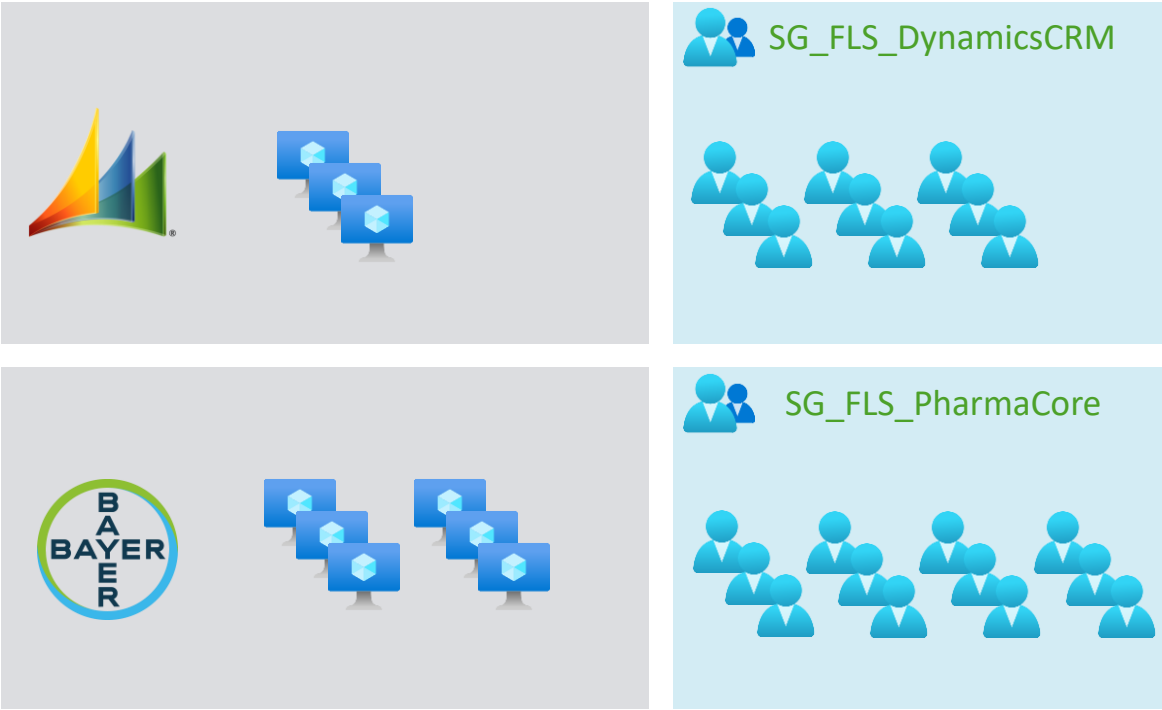
- No data persistence
- Limited region availability



Final Words…

Use Cases & Scenarios

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Windows 365 Business	Windows 365 Enterprise	Windows 365 Frontline (D)	Windows 365 Frontline (S)
Remote & hybrid work for SMBs	Enterprise-wide remote workforce	Shift-based roles	Task-based
BYOD for employees		Part-time and seasonal employees	Kiosk scenarios
		Contractors	Secure access to specific apps
			Labs, training rooms

Nerdio – Windows 365 Insights

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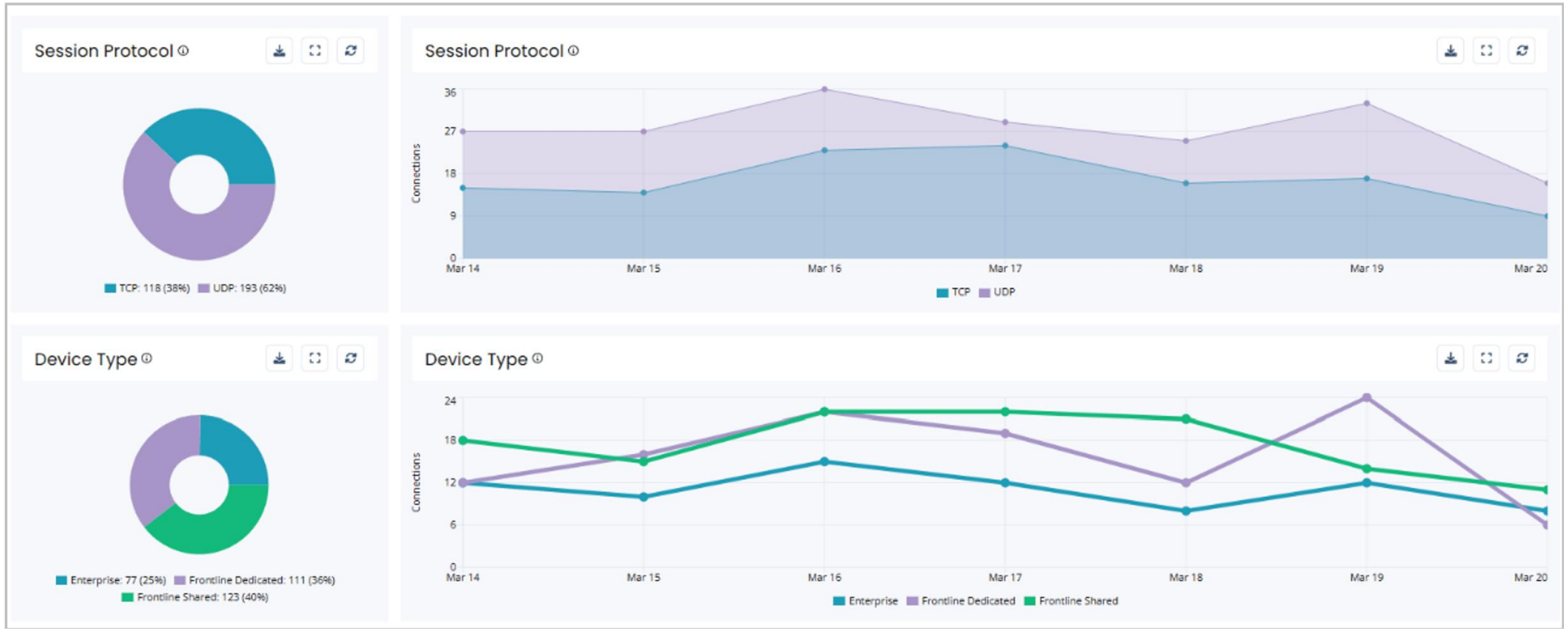

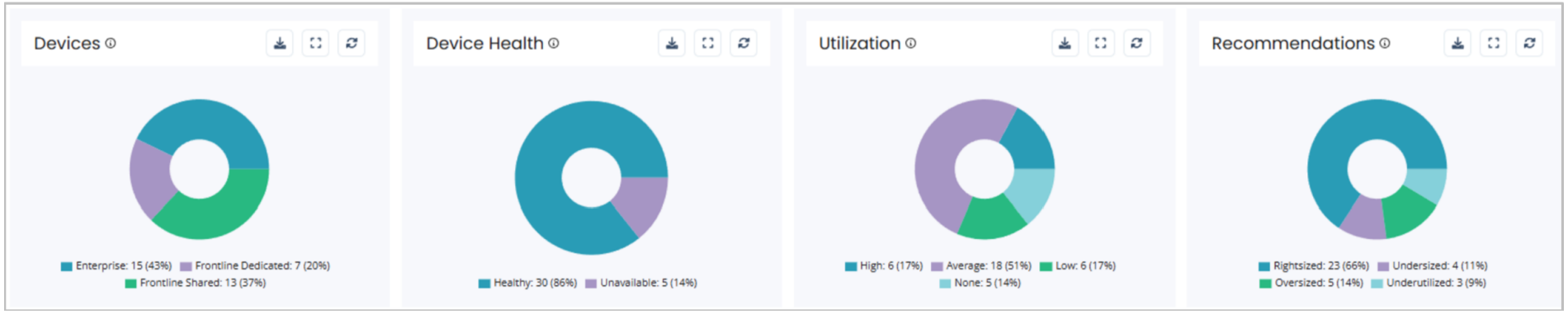

Nerdio Advisor: Platform TCO

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RECOMMENDATIONS DASHBOARD

Search...

FILTER BY RULE: Platform TCO (AVD personal) (CLONE)

FILTER BY STATUS: Include No Active

FILTER BY SCOPE: Personal Desktop

Compliant AVD Desktops
AVD to Windows 365

TOTAL RESOURCES: 5

TOTAL RECOMMENDATIONS: 3

DESKTOP	CURRENT CONFIGURATION	UPTIME (LAST 30 DAYS)	RECOMMENDATION	COST & RESOURCE IMPACT	
64gbos-211b.nerdio.int (Spring Update Workspace / Personal Desktop)	AVD Personal Desktop **VM Size:** B4ms (4C & 16GB) **Disk:** 64 GB (E6/Standard SSD)	Total Uptime: 0.0h (0%) **Connected:** 0.0h (0%)	None	✓ Compliant	Details
nme-cu-mon-1.nerdio.int (Spring Update Workspace / Personal Desktop)	AVD Personal Desktop **VM Size:** B2s (2C & 4GB) **Disk:** 128 GB (E10/Standard SSD)	Total Uptime: 134.2h (19%) **Connected:** 0.0h (0%)	Windows 365 Enterprise **Size:** 2 Cores, 4GB RAM **Disk:** 128GB	-$16.76 (28.3%) per month **Cores:** No change **RAM:** No change **Disk:** No change	Details
nme-cu-mon-2.nerdio.int (Spring Update Workspace / Personal Desktop)	AVD Personal Desktop **VM Size:** B2s (2C & 4GB) **Disk:** 128 GB (E10/Standard SSD)	Total Uptime: 87.9h (14%) **Connected:** 2.1h (0%)	Windows 365 Enterprise **Size:** 2 Cores, 4GB RAM **Disk:** 128GB	-$15.25 (26.4%) per month **Cores:** No change **RAM:** No change **Disk:** No change	Details

Nerdio Advisor: Righ-sizing

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RECOMMENDATIONS DASHBOARD

Search...

FILTER BY RULE: Right-sizing (Cloud PC)

FILTER BY STATUS: Select...

FILTER BY CLOUD PC SIZE: Select...

TOTAL RESOURCES: 7

TOTAL RECOMMENDATIONS: 7

RESOURCE	CURRENT CONFIGURATION	AVERAGE USAGE	RECOMMENDATION TYPE	COST IMPACT	
David-PC User: dbowie@getnerdio.com Mar 22, 2025 08:07 PM	WINDOWS 365 FRONTLINE DEDICATED Size: 8 Cores, 32GB RAM Disk: 128GB	Utilized Time: 168.0h Used Storage: 50.0GB CPU 37% MEM 47% more...	Decrease	-$57.00	Details
George-PC User: gharrison@getnerdio.com Mar 22, 2025 08:07 PM	WINDOWS 365 ENTERPRISE Size: 2 Cores, 8GB RAM Disk: 128GB	Utilized Time: 40.0h Used Storage: 48.0GB CPU 91% MEM 50% more...	Increase	+$9.00	Details
Jacky-PC User: jjackson@getnerdio.com Mar 22, 2025 08:07 PM	WINDOWS 365 ENTERPRISE Size: 8 Cores, 32GB RAM Disk: 128GB	Utilized Time: 0.5h Used Storage: 47.0GB CPU 70% MEM 70% more...	License Reclaim	-$123.00	Details

Thank you

Session Feedback

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